

Chairing: opening the meeting

Worksheet

- A** At the beginning of a meeting the chairperson has a lot to do. Put these tasks in a likely order. One has been done for you.

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|---|---|---|-----------------------------------|
| a | Asking somebody to introduce the first item | 1 | |
| b | Welcoming and thanking everybody | 2 | |
| c | Explaining the objectives of the meeting | 3 | <i>Introducing new colleagues</i> |
| d | Introducing new colleagues | 4 | |
| e | Getting everybody's attention | 5 | |
| f | Looking at the agenda | 6 | |

- B** Complete the table with words from the box.

Right purpose get through item agenda background
say a few words at such short notice facing distribute

Getting attention	(1) _____, is everybody here? Good, I think we can start.
Welcoming and thanking	Well, good morning everyone. Do you all have a copy of the (2) _____? I'd like to thank you all for being here (3) _____
Introducing new colleagues	First of all, I'd like to introduce Hiroshi from our Tokyo office. Would you like to (4) _____ about yourself, Hiroshi?
Explaining the objectives	The main (5) _____ of this meeting is to ... The problem we're (6) _____ is that ...
Looking at the agenda	You can see from the agenda that we have a lot to (7) _____. I've prepared some figures to help us compare the two options. I'll (8) _____ them now.
Asking somebody to start	Okay, let's move straight to the first (9) _____. Kim, would you like to kick off? Ana, would you like to begin by explaining the (10) _____?

- C** Write the opening comments for a real meeting that you are going to have (or recently had) in your job. Use real names and real agenda items. Consider these points:

- Do you have to introduce anybody?
- Do you have to mention any 'housekeeping' points like arrangements for coffee, the finish time, where the bathroom is etc.?
- Do you need to explain the objectives of the meeting?
- Do you need to explain the procedure of the meeting (the structure, who will speak etc.)?
- Do you have to review any tasks done since the previous meeting?
- Do you need to give any background information?
- How are you going to move into the first item?

Practise your opening comments. Start by reading them, then try without using your notes.

